

Balancing immunosuppression

Induction vs. maintenance

Complications

TRANSPLANT MEDICINE

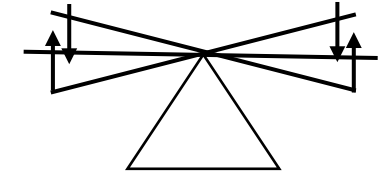
Oversuppression

Undersuppression



Click anywhere to continue.

Immunosuppression



Rejection

Infection
Cancer

Degree of immunosuppression

Lung > Heart/ Kidney > Liver

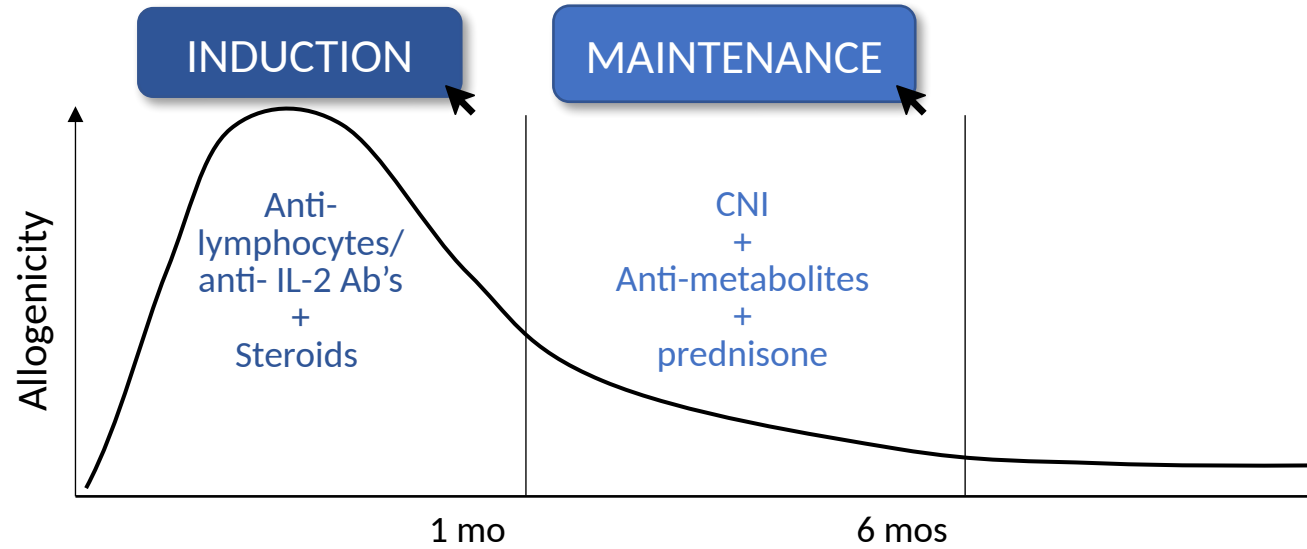
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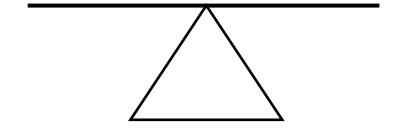
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MEDICATIONS



Click anywhere to continue.

Immunosuppression



Rejection

Infection
Cancer

Degree of immunosuppression

Lung > Heart/ Kidney > Liver

CNI
Anti-met
Pred

CNI
Anti-met
± Pred

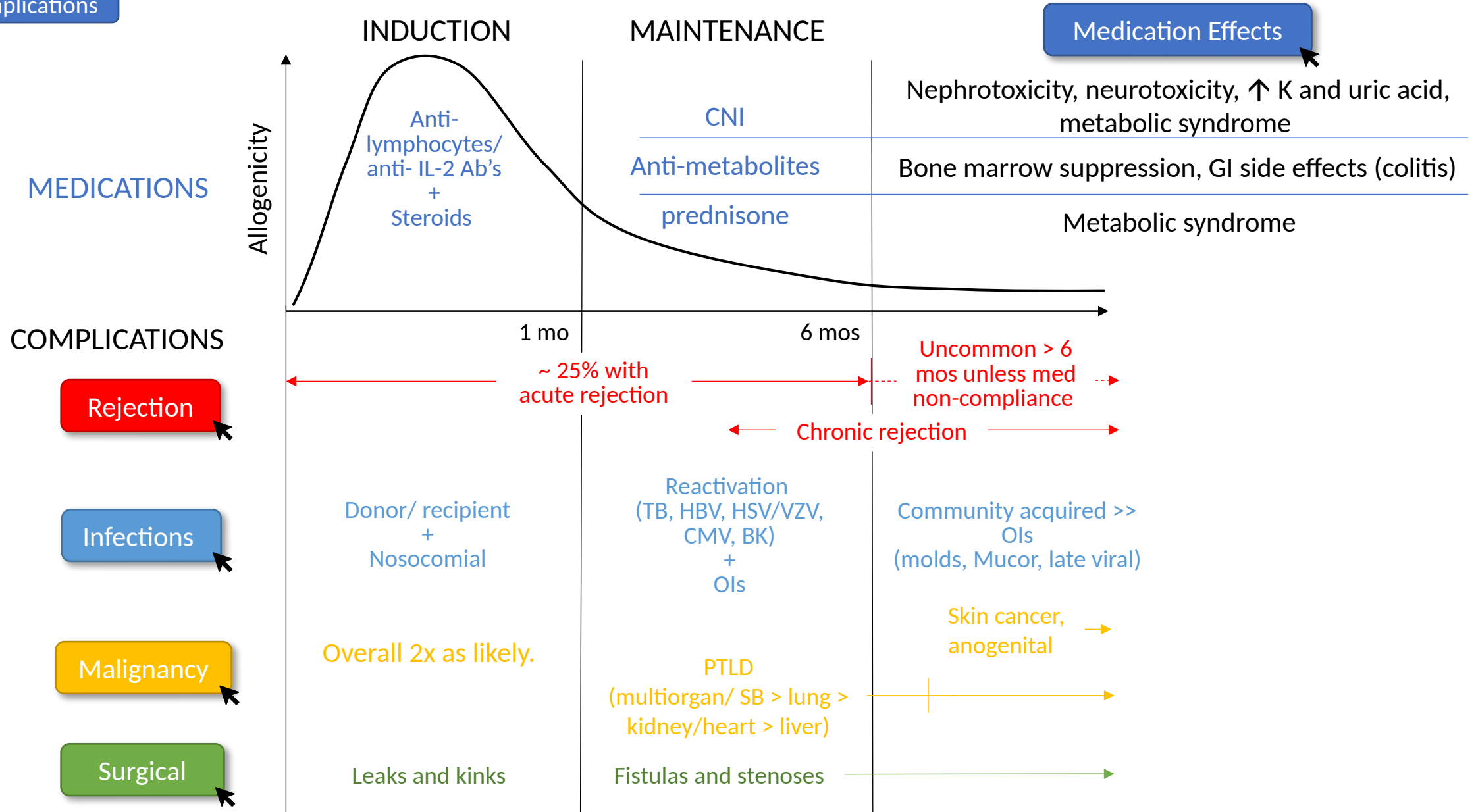
CNI

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Newer Context (2011–2023)

Belatacept (Nulojix, FDA 2011) — CNI-sparing maintenance

CD28/CD80-86 costimulation blocker; better long-term GFR & fewer donor-specific Abs vs CNI (BENEFIT). CONTRAINDICATED if EBV-seronegative (PTLD/CNS-PTLD, PML risk).

Induction depleting agents have shifted

OKT3 / muromonab-CD3 discontinued 2010; current depleting agents = rabbit ATG, alemtuzumab. Non-depleting = basiliximab (anti-IL-2R).

CMV prophylaxis options expanded

Letermovir (Prevymis) FDA-approved Jun 2023 for high-risk (D+/R-) kidney transplant — alternative to valganciclovir with less myelosuppression. Maribavir (Livtensity, FDA 2021) for refractory/resistant CMV.

Take-Home Points

Immunosuppression is a constant balance: less rejection vs. more infection, cancer, and drug toxicity.

Allogenicity (rejection risk) is highest in the first month and falls over time — so does the intensity of immunosuppression. Lung > heart/kidney > liver.

Assuming adherence, a FIRST episode of acute rejection beyond 6 months is highly unlikely.

Reactivation infections (CMV, BK, HSV/VZV, TB, HBV) cluster at 1–6 months; nosocomial/donor-derived <1 month; community-acquired >6 months.

PTLD occurs early (first year, EBV-driven); most other malignancies appear late. Overall cancer risk ~2× general population.

Attribution & Changelog

Adapted from TeachIM.org — “Transplant Medicine” (Yilin Zhang MD, Brandon Fainstad MD; published Dec 2020).

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Optimized 2026-06-11. Corrections (learner board): “mycophenylate”→“mycophenolate”; “bortezumab”→“bortezomib”. Presenter board: no text errors found.

Added a newer-context slide (belatacept; OKT3 discontinued; letermovir/maribavir CMV) — standing teaching unchanged. All original click-to-reveal animations/graphics preserved.

Companion files: Transplant-Medicine-Handout.docx; Transplant-Medicine-Learner-Board-1.pptx (corrected). Educational use only — clinician-review before teaching.